Practice workbook · Operant conditioning: rewards and punishments that shape crime

Reinforcement, punishment and primary/secondary reinforcers as an explanation of offending.

12 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 11 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-CRI-01

# 1. Question 9 · part whole · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 02

Worked-example retry · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

**9** The police caught Tamara driving over the legal speed limit. She was required to attend a course about the dangers of driving over the speed limit as a punishment for her offence. A month after the course, she was caught driving over the speed limit again when she was nearly involved in a road traffic accident.

Explain how negative punishment could be used to stop Tamara from driving over the speed limit in the future.

**(Total for Question 9 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 2. Question 8 · part whole · 1 mark

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

**8** A prisoner receives a token for good behaviour, which they can then exchange for extra food in the canteen.

Identify which type of reinforcer the token would be.

- ☒ **A** Primary reinforcer
- ☒ **B** Negative reinforcer
- ☒ **C** Secondary reinforcer
- ☒ **D** Vicarious reinforcer

**(Total for Question 8 = 1 mark)**

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Working and answer

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## 3. Question 14 · part whole · 9 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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***14** Maurice is 34 years old and has been stealing since he was 16 years old. He has stolen high value items such as a television, and low value items such as food. He says that stealing stops him feeling like he cannot give his family the things they deserve.

Maurice has only been caught stealing once, and was given a community sentence of two months. He says it is not worth stopping stealing because he gets lots of nice things that he enjoys. He also says that the consequence of being punished does not worry him.

Assess how well operant conditioning can explain Maurice's stealing.

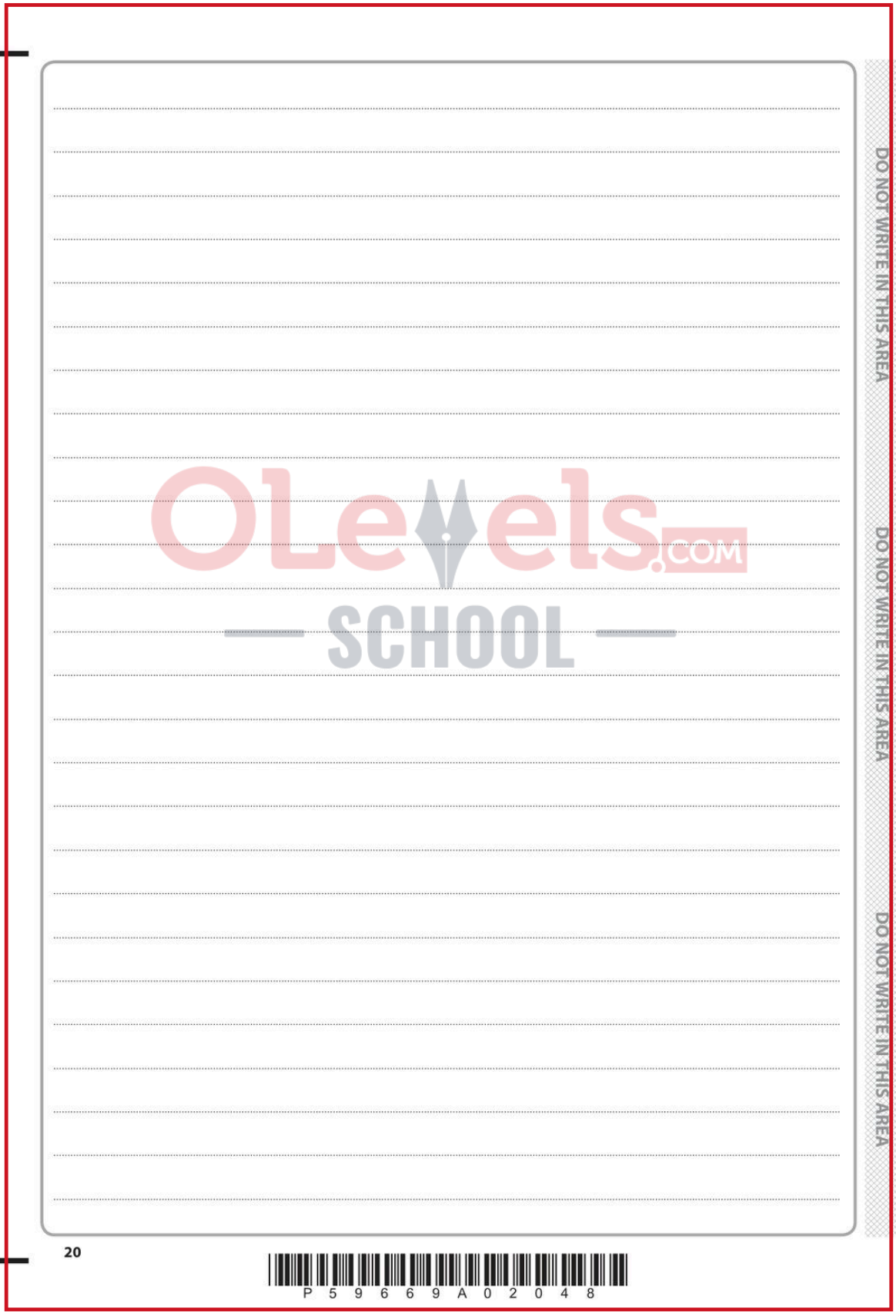
**(9)**

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## 3. Question 14 · part whole · 9 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



## 3. Question 14 · part whole · 9 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



## 3. Question 14 · part whole · 9 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 4. Question 9 · part whole · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

**9** Melanie repeatedly drives in excess of the speed limit. She was caught exceeding the speed limit by the police and was given a verbal warning to stay within the speed limit.

Explain **one** weakness of using a verbal warning to prevent Melanie exceeding the speed limit in the future.

You must use a theory to justify your answer.

**(Total for Question 9 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 5. Question 12 · part whole · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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**12** Niall has been behaving antisocially. He broke his neighbours' window when throwing stones and then scratched their car when they told him off. His parents have removed his games console for two weeks.

Explain **one** way that removing the games console might change Niall's behaviour in the future.

You must use operant conditioning to justify your answer.

**(Total for Question 12 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 6. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN

**7** State what is meant by a 'secondary reinforcer'.

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**(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)**

Working and answer

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## 7. Question 11 · part whole · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

**11** Edward is 14 years old and has started behaving antisocially. He has been playing loud music in the park and swearing at staff in the local shop. Edward has been referred to a young offenders support worker.

The support worker intends to only use positive punishment to help Edward with his behaviour.

Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using positive punishment with Edward to improve his behaviour.

Strength

Weakness

**(Total for Question 11 = 4 marks)**

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## 7. Question 11 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

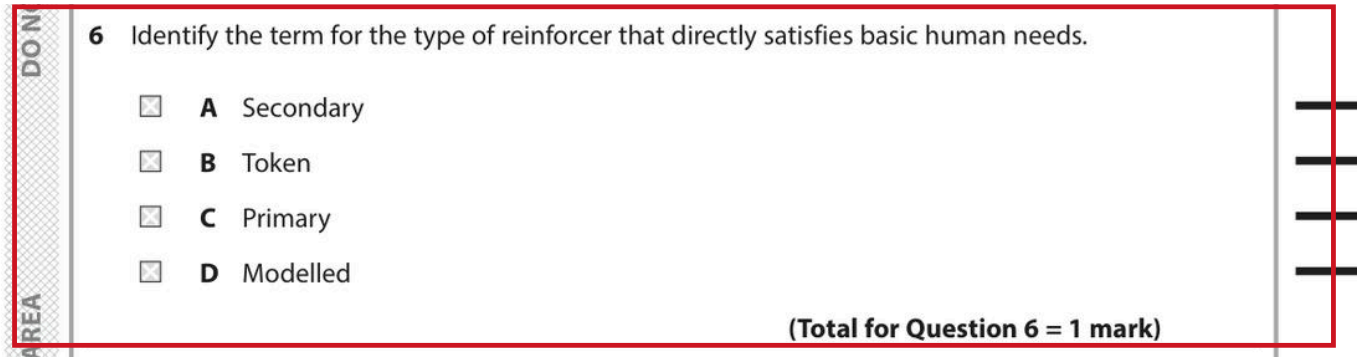
Working and answer

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## 8. Question 6 · part whole · 1 mark

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.



**6** Identify the term for the type of reinforcer that directly satisfies basic human needs.

- ☒ **A** Secondary
- ☒ **B** Token
- ☒ **C** Primary
- ☒ **D** Modelled

**(Total for Question 6 = 1 mark)**

Working and answer

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## 9. Question 8 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

**8** Describe how negative reinforcement could encourage criminal behaviour.

**(Total for Question 8 = 2 marks)**

Working and answer

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## 10. Question 9 · part whole · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

**9** Li is struggling to manage his anger in situations where he finds himself in conflict with others. He has already been given several warnings from the police for shouting abusive comments at other people and for threatening behaviour.

The police have assigned a support worker to meet with Li once a week to help him learn to behave in a less aggressive way.

Explain how positive reinforcement could be used to help Li behave in a less aggressive way.

**(Total for Question 9 = 2 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 11. Question 7 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

DO NOT WRITE IN THIS AREA

**7** Identify the term used to describe a reinforcer that is exchanged for an item that an individual wants or needs.

- ☒ **A** Primary
- ☒ **B** Secondary
- ☒ **C** Tertiary
- ☒ **D** Quaternary

**(Total for Question 7 = 1 mark)**

Working and answer

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## 12. Question 8 · part whole · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 02

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

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**8** State what is meant by 'positive punishment'.

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**(Total for Question 8 = 1 mark)**

Working and answer

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